

To: Head of Growth; Head of Seller Operations

From: Julia Obe, DA HNG14

Date: 2006-04-23

Subject: TradeZone Performance Review and Key Business Insights for 2023–2024

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

TradeZone's 2023–2024 performance is concentrated around a limited set of sellers who generate most revenue through high order volumes, strong customer ratings, and faster delivery times. Operational efficiency is uneven, with fulfilment speed and service quality clearly separating top sellers from the rest of the marketplace. At the same time, customer behaviour varies by state and payment method, while product ratings show only a partial relationship with revenue, indicating that execution and seller performance matter more than product perception alone.

KEY FINDINGS

The three most significant findings discovered from the eight queries are:

Key 1:

From Query 8 (Top Seller Bonus Qualification), StyleKraft NG leads in total order volume (40 orders) with a strong average rating of 4.2, showing that consistent demand and operational capacity are key drivers of revenue. In contrast, HomeNest NG achieves the highest customer satisfaction score (4.73) with 30 orders, indicating that superior product experience and service quality can sustain strong demand even without being the highest-volume seller. Together, they show that revenue growth is powered by either high transaction volume or exceptional customer trust, with the strongest sellers balancing both dimensions.

Key 2:

From Query 3 (Seller Fulfilment Efficiency), Fulfilment performance shows a clear but non-linear relationship between delivery speed, order volume, and customer satisfaction across sellers. For example, a seller with an average fulfilment time of 110.57 hours completed 28 orders and achieved a moderate rating of 3.38, while another faster seller at 93.81 hours handled 22 orders but recorded a lower rating of 2.92, suggesting that speed alone does not guarantee better customer experience. In contrast, a seller with 102.32 hours fulfilment time achieved both high order volume (37 orders) and strong satisfaction (4.17 rating), indicating that consistency and service quality alongside reasonable delivery speed are more critical drivers of customer trust than speed in isolation.

Key 3:

From Query 7 (Review Ratings and Sales performance), Product performance shows a clear imbalance between customer perception and revenue contribution. Mid-rated products dominate revenue generation with 118 products contributing the highest total revenue, despite not having the strongest customer satisfaction scores. High-rated products account for 114 items, while low-rated products are only 33 but generate the lowest revenue, indicating limited market traction. This pattern suggests that sales are being driven more by exposure, availability, or promotion rather than product quality alone, pointing to inefficiencies in how products are surfaced and prioritized within the platform's marketing and recommendation systems.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Improve inconsistent seller fulfilment performance: Assign the **Seller Operations team** to target sellers with high variability in fulfilment time (around 90–110 hours) and inconsistent ratings. Introduce structured operational coaching focused on order processing speed, dispatch coordination, and delivery execution discipline.

Expected outcome (60–90 days): Reduced variability in fulfilment times and improved customer ratings, with more sellers stabilizing at ≥ 4.0 , leading to stronger customer trust and repeat purchases.

Rebalance product visibility toward quality-driven sales: Assign the **Growth / Merchandising team** to review product ranking and recommendation logic, reducing overexposure of mid-rated products (118 products currently driving highest revenue) and increasing visibility of high-rated products (114 products).

Expected outcome (60–90 days): Improved alignment between product ratings and revenue contribution, higher conversion from high-rated products, and stronger overall customer satisfaction and retention.

DATA QUALITY NOTES

1.

Duplicate values in the email column posed a data quality issue because emails were generated by combining first_name and last_name, making them non-unique identifiers. Instead of deleting records and losing valid data, customers were identified using their combined names. This issue could have led to inaccurate counts of unique customers, affecting analyses on customer behaviour, repeat purchases, and segmentation, potentially distorting insights derived from the dataset.

2.

Inconsistencies between orders.total_amount and the aggregated order_items.line_total introduced a risk of inaccurate revenue calculations, which could have distorted seller performance, product revenue, and overall financial analysis. This was resolved by recalculating totals from order items, updating 2,996 affected records, and validating differences using discrepancy checks. This ensured that all revenue-based insights were derived from accurate and consistent transactional data.

WHAT THE DATA CANNOT TELL US?

One critical business question this dataset cannot answer is:

“What is the actual profitability of sellers and products?”

While the analysis shows revenue, order volume, ratings, and fulfilment efficiency, it does not include cost-related data such as product cost, logistics cost, discounts, or platform fees. This means leadership cannot determine whether top-selling products or high-revenue sellers are truly profitable or simply generating high sales at low or negative margins.

Additional Data Required

To answer this, you would need:

- Shipping and fulfilment costs per order
- Discounts and promotions applied